

Richard Kwame Appiah

CYBERSECURITY PROFESSIONAL · SOC · PENETRATION TESTING · GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 9+ years securing financial, telecommunications, and critical infrastructure environments. Expertise in SIEM monitoring, incident investigation, red team operations, and penetration testing, with strong ISO/IEC 27001:2022 governance and compliance experience. Skilled at turning technical findings into remediation plans and executive-ready security reporting.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Security Operations	SIEM monitoring · Incident response · Threat detection · Escalation management · Security tool integration
Offensive Security	Penetration testing · Red team ops · Phishing simulations · Vulnerability assessment · SAST/DAST
Governance & Risk	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 · Risk assessment · Access control · Policy drafting · Audit support · Non-conformance tracking
Infrastructure	Data center operations · Network defense · Active Directory · Endpoint protection · IT documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems & Applications Specialist / Data Center NOC Support

Jan 2023 – Present

Bank of Ghana (FICSOC) — Virtual InfoSec Africa · Accra, Ghana

- Monitor network and application performance with SIEM tooling to detect anomalies and resolve issues early.
- Lead end-to-end incident investigations with clear documentation for operational handoff and executive reporting.
- Support security tool and application integrations that strengthen overall system security posture.
- Provide escalation support for high-severity incidents; monitor data center power, cooling, cabling, and hardware for uptime and facility security.
- Coordinate vendors and contractors on equipment delivery and installation to keep infrastructure projects on schedule.

Penetration Tester / External IT Audit Representative

Jul 2019 – Nov 2022

Sophies Group · Ghana, Nigeria & Tanzania

- Executed red team operations—including phishing simulations and payload delivery—to identify and exploit security weaknesses.
- Assessed infrastructure vulnerabilities with industry-standard tools; delivered prioritized remediation guidance and executive-ready reports.
- Performed static and dynamic code analysis on custom applications to uncover vulnerabilities and improve security posture.
- Audited system configurations, access controls, and firewall policies; assessed physical security of critical infrastructure.
- Implemented breach detection protocols and recommended improvements to perimeter defenses and endpoint protection.
- Trained 60+ staff in phishing awareness and cyber hygiene; validated security controls during Accra City Hotel systems migration.

Equipment Audit / Commercial Representative

Mar 2021 – Mar 2022

Helios Towers Ghana

- Validated data quality across 500+ tower sites and produced analytics reports to guide operational improvements.

- Reconciled field data with GIS mapping for telecom audits; developed risk mitigation and compliance trackers for stakeholders.
- Coordinated with engineering teams on EPA allowances and power optimization; supported contract verification and data management.

IT Support

Sep 2017 – Sep 2018

GRIDCo (Ghana Grid Company Limited)

- Resolved hardware/software issues and provided first-line Active Directory and Exchange support to minimize downtime.
- Assisted with backup/restore operations, security patching, anti-malware deployment, workstation rollouts, and cabling.

IT Support (MIS)

Mar 2016 – May 2016

Volta River Authority

- Maintained the MIS system and resolved hardware, software, and network issues; supported inventory, backups, and equipment setup.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BSc, Information Technology — Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (Expected Jan 2027)

Associate Degree, Information Technology — Ghana Communication Technology University (Jan 2016)

Training: Critical Infrastructure Protection (U.S. DHS) · DoD CUI / RMF / Physical Security (DCSA) · ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Certified Auditor (Mastermind Assurance) · Ethical Hacking (IPMC) · Project Planning & Risk Management (UC Irvine)

CERTIFICATIONS

- TÜV SÜD — ISO 27001:2022 Certified Lead Implementer
- EC-Council — Certified SOC Analyst (CSA)
- The SecOps Group — Certified Network Security Practitioner
- TCM Security — Practical Ethical Hacking
- TCM Security — Practical Windows Forensics
- Oracle University — OCI Architect Associate
- Cisco Networking Academy — Network Defense
- LogRhythm (Exabeam) — Platform Administrator
- LogRhythm (Exabeam) — Security Analyst
- OneTrust — Incident Management Expert
- Lean Six Sigma White Belt — PMI / Process Management International